

CHAPTER

18



Masurika Romantika

Learning Objectives

- ⇒ To understand the concept of Masurika
- ⇒ To understand the Nidana of Masurika mentioned in Ayurveda literatures
- ⇒ To learn about Samprapti of Masurika
- ⇒ To enlist the types of Masurika
- ⇒ To explain Avasthika Lakshana of Masurika
- ⇒ To enlist the features of Romantika

Introduction

Masurika and *Romantika* are the spectra of diseases which are categorised under *Upasargajanya Vikara*. Here, the term *Upasarga* refers to close contact with the individual suffering from the disease. This is composed of two words – *Upa* and *Sarga*. The word *Upa* means near and *Sarga* refers to staying together. If you add these two words, the word *Upasarga* means the normal individual staying together (sitting together or performing sexual activity or eating together or sleeping together or taking the food in one plate or taking inspiration which air is being expelled out by the ill-healthy individuals or by using the clothes used by the diseased individuals) with the individual

having disease having mild to severe disease. The severity of the presenting complaints depends upon the nature of *Dosha* vitiated in the body, the status of the affliction of *Dhatu* in the body, exposure of *Nidana* into the body from different orifices in the body, virulence of *Nidana* to the body, physical or mental strength of the individual at the time of affliction of the disease, the functional status of *Agni* (digestive fire) etc.

Masurika

दाहज्वररुजावन्तस्ताम्राः स्फोटाः सपीतकाः।

गात्रेषु वदने चान्तर्विज्ञेयास्ता मसूरिकाः॥

सु.नि. - 13/36

This disease¹ is associated with skin eruptions that are

- 1 The clinical features of Masurika are similar to the clinical features of chickenpox. This is a ubiquitous, extremely infectious disease. This is a benign illness of the childhood characterised by exanthematous rash.
 - The incubation period of chickenpox is 10 to 21 days. On an average, 14-17 days is the usual incubation period of the highly contagious infection. Disease transmission is more efficient in temperate than in tropical climates. Patients are infectious 48 hours of the onset of the vesicular rash, during the period of vesicle formation (which generally lasts 4-5 days), and until are vesicles are crusted. 99% of the cases occur in 10 to 20 days after the exposure. A single attack of chickenpox usually confers lifetime immunity.
 - Clinically, chickenpox presents as a rash, low grade fever and malaise.
 - The skin lesions, the hall mark of the disease, include maculopapules, vesicles and scabs in various stages of infection. These eruptions which evolve from maculopapules to vesicles over hours to days, appear on the face and trunk and rapidly spread to other areas of the body. Most are small and have erythematous base with a diameter of 5-10 mm. Some lesions can also be found on the pharyngeal mucosa and vaginal mucosa.
 - The most common complication of chickenpox is secondary bacterial superinfection of the skin. Aseptic meningitis, encephalitis, transverse myelitis, Guillain Barre Syndrome, varicella pneumonia are some other complications observed in the patients of chickenpox. Myocarditis, corneal lesions, nephritis, arthritis, bleeding diatheses, acute glomerulonephritis and hepatitis are some other complications seen in the patients of chickenpox.
- Skin lesions of the patient of chickenpox
- The diagnosis of chickenpox is not difficult. The characteristic rashes and a history of recent exposure should lead to a prompt diagnosis.

associated with *Daha* (burning sensation), *Jvara* (raised body temperature), *Ruja* (pain), *Tamra Sphota* (coppery coloured skin eruptions) which may turn into *Pita Varna* (yellowish discolouration) observed in different parts of the body as well as face.

पित्तं शोणितसंस्पृष्टं यदा दूषयति त्वचम्।

तदा करोति पिडकाः सर्वगात्रेषु देहिनः॥

मसूरमुद्रमाषाणां तुल्याः कोलोपमा इति।

मसूरिकास्तु विज्ञेयाः पिडका रक्तपित्तजाः॥

There will be dominance of *Pitta Dosha* and involvement of *Rakta* in *Tvak*

In *Masurika*², skin eruptions³ all over the body – the skin eruptions are of the size of *Masura* (lentil), *Mudga* (green gram) or *Masha* (black gram)

Romantika

Romantika is a type of skin eruption. As per *Madhukosha* commentary, this is a variety of *Masurika*. It is preceded by raised body temperature followed by reddish skin eruptions. It implies the involvement of *Rasa* and *Rakta Dhātu* during the pathogenesis. This is not explained by *Sushruta*. This is explained by *Madhavakara* in the description of *Masurika*.

- Replication of the virus is believed to occur initially in the epithelial cells of the mucosa of the upper respiratory tract. This disease produces widespread skin eruptions, here we can assume blood distribution and virus can be isolated from WBCs from 5 days before to 2 days after the appearance of the rash.
In case of immunocompromised patients, the inflammatory changes can occur in lung, liver, spleen, skin together with anoxic changes in the brain.
- The disease is characterised by generalised skin eruption with centripetal distribution; erythematous macules, papules, vesicles and scabbed lesions may be present at the same time. Vesicles are superficial with varying amounts of erythema at their bases. Adults tend to have more erythema than children. During early phase of infection, eruptions found in face, scalp and trunk. Later new lesions appear on the extremities. By this time, earlier lesions are dried and crusted. Excoriations are common. Mucous membranes of oropharynx and conjunctiva are afflicted during the progression of the disease.
- The clinical features of measles resemble the clinical features of *Romantika*. Measles is a highly contagious, acute, exanthematous respiratory disease with characteristic clinical feature and presence of Koplik's spots, eruptions observed in buccal mucosa.
- When the individual is exposed to above said etiological factors will lead to the reduction of overall immune status of the individual. In the following, we are going to discuss how each of the *Nidana* exposure may lead to abnormal changes in the body and thereby the individual is susceptible to above said etiological factors, may develop skin eruptions having the size of *Masura* (lentil).
- Katu*, *Amla*, *Lavana Rasa Sevana*, *Kshara Sevana*, *Viruddha Ahara Sevana* and *Adhyashana*, consumption of contaminated water are the factors which lead to the vitiation of *Dosha* i.e. *Dosha Hetu*. As per *Ayurveda* fundamentals, these *Rasa* are responsible for the vitiation of *Pitta Dosha* in the body. These factors will weaken the physical and immunological strength of the individuals. Because of this, the individuals are susceptible for the appearance of any type of disease, some type of the infections too.
- As per fundamentals of *Ayurveda*, excess consumption of *Kshara* (alkaline) substances will lead to the vitiation of *Pitta Dosha* in the body. As per current understanding, excess consumption of alkaline substances will lead to neutralisation of the hydrochloric acid (HCl) present in gastric juice. When neutralisation of gastric juice occurs, that will lead to the hampered inactivation of pepsinogen into pepsin wherein the digestion of substances in the stomach will be hampered. Thus, the person may have digestive impairment.
- When an individual is continuously indulging *Viruddha Ahara* (incompatible food substances), that will lead to inflammation of stomach as these food substances are considered as irritants to the stomach and these substances may remain in the stomach after ingestion at least for a period of 2 hours.
 - This will lead to a state of *Agnimandya*, i.e. poor gastric juice formation i.e. hampered HCl secretion (normal pH is 1-8 to 3.5) which in turn leads to alkalinity of gastric juice (pH > 3.5) the poor conversion of pepsinogen into pepsin; where the macromolecules entering into the stomach from the mouth at the time of ingestion, will not be converted into intermediate or micromolecules
 - This will lead to poor assimilation of the micromolecules formed, as the concentration of micromolecules formed is very less. This will lead to the conversion of macromolecules present in the tissues itself.
 - Thus, the person may have weakened resistance power.
- The term *Adhyashana* refers to the consumption of food substances prior to the digestion of previously ingested meal. The sequel of this type of food consumption is *Agnimandya* (poor digestive fire). Refer the context of *Agnimandya* in the context of *Agnimandya* and *Ajirna* description.

रोमकूपोन्नतिसमा रागिण्यः कफपित्तजाः।

कासारोचकसंयुक्ता रोमान्त्यो ज्वरपूर्विकाः॥

मा.नि. - 54/13

*Romantika*⁴ is characterised by skin eruptions which arise at the root of hair follicles with slight elevation. They are red in colour. It is caused due to the dominance of *Kapha* and *Pitta Dosha*. there can be association of the symptoms like *Kasa* (cough) and *Arochaka* (tastelessness). The disease is always preceded by *Jvara* (raised body temperature).

Causative factors of Masurika⁵

कद्वम्ललवणक्षारविरुद्धाध्यशनाशनैः।

दुष्टनिष्पावशाकाद्यैः प्रदुष्टपवनोदकैः॥

क्रूरग्रहेक्षणाच्चापि देशे दोषाः समुद्भवाः।

जनयन्ति शरीरेऽस्मिन् दुष्टरक्तेन सङ्गताः॥

मसूराकृतिसंस्थानाः पिडकाः स्युर्मसूरिकाः।

मा.नि. - 54/1-3

- Katu*, *Amla* and *Lavana Rasa Sevana*⁶ – excess consumption of substances having pungent, sour and salt taste
- Kshara Sevana*⁷ – consumption of alkaline substances
- Viruddha Ashana*⁸ – excess consumption of antagonistic food and drinks
- Adhyashana*⁹ – consumption of food substances prior

- to the digestion of previously ingested meals
- ⊗ **Dushta Nishpava and Shaka**¹⁰ – regular consumption of contaminated beans, leafy vegetables
- ⊗ **Pradushta Pavanodaka**¹¹ – continuous exposure to contaminated air and water
- ⊗ **Krura Grahekshana** – bad planetary influences of certain parts of the country

Samprapti

- ⊗ There will be the vitiation of *Pitta Dosha* and *Rakta Dhatu* which circulates all over the body.
- ⊗ The site of the localisation of the vitiated *Dosha* is *Tvak* (skin) leading to skin eruptions.
- ⊗ Nature of skin eruption resembles *Masura* (lentil), *Mudga* (green gram) or *Masha* (black gram)

Samprapti Ghataka

- ⊗ **Dosha** : *Pitta*
- ⊗ **Dushya** : *Rakta*
- ⊗ **Srotas** : *Raktavaha Srotas*
- ⊗ **Srotodushti** : *Sanga* and *Vimargagamana*
- ⊗ **Agni** : *Jatharagnimandya*
- ⊗ **Ama** : *Jatharagnijanya*
- ⊗ **Udbhava Sthana** : *Amashaya*¹² (as this is *Upasargaja Vikara*, first there will be appearance of discomfort, later after a period of 7 days, *Amashaya* will be

- Udbhava Sthana*)
- ⊗ **Sanchara Sthana** : *Sarva Sharira*
- ⊗ **Vyakta Sthana** : *Tvak*
- ⊗ **Rogamarga** : *Abhyantara* and *Bahya* (order of the clinical manifestation of the symptoms)
- ⊗ **Vyadhi Svabhava** : *Ashukari*
- ⊗ **Sadhysadhyata** : *Sukhasadhyata*

Purvarupa

- तासां पूर्व ज्वरः कण्डूगात्रभङ्गोऽरतिर्भ्रमः।
त्वचि शोथः सवैवर्ण्यी नेत्ररागश्च जायते॥
- ⊗ **Jvara**¹³ : Raised body temperature
 - ⊗ **Kandu**¹⁴ : Itching
 - ⊗ **Gatrabhanga**¹⁵ : Pain all over the body
 - ⊗ **Arati**¹⁶ : Restlessness
 - ⊗ **Bhrama**¹⁷ : Giddiness
 - ⊗ **Tvachi Shoph**¹⁸ : Swelling in the skin
 - ⊗ **Vaivarnya**¹⁹ : Discolouration of the skin
 - ⊗ **Netraraga**²⁰ : Redness of the eyes

मा.नि. - 54/4

Samanya Lakshana of Masurika

- दाहज्वररुजावन्तस्तापः स्फोटः सपीतकाः।
गात्रेषु वदने चान्तर्विज्ञेयास्ता मसूरिकाः॥
- ⊗ **Sphota**²¹ (skin eruptions) that are associated with

सु.नि. - 13/36

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- Consumption of these substances may lead to the inflammation of the stomach as the food substances after consumption may remain in the stomach for almost 2 hours.
- Here, *Pradushta Pavanodaka* refers to contaminated air and water. Contaminated air intake indicates the person is inhaling the air containing microorganisms or air particles. Whereas contaminated water consumption is swallowing the water having microorganisms or harmful chemicals. Exposure to contaminated air will lead to the affliction of respiratory system and contaminated water consumption may lead to affliction of alimentary canal.
- At the beginning before seven days of the manifestation of the disease, it is futile to give the medicine for correction of *Amashaya* without giving treatment for correcting *Rakta* as *Amashaya* is not afflicted in the initial phase of disease manifestation. Initially, *Rakta Dhatu* is afflicted and you have to give treatment for the improvement of *Rakta*. After 7 days, you can observe the affliction of *Amashaya*.
- As the person is having weak physical and immunological status, exposure to any degree of pathological agent, may lead to the manifestation of fever because of the interaction between the existing WBCs and pathological agents.
- As per western medicine, chickenpox is considered as pruritic infection. This disease involves respiratory system, integumentary system presented with running nose, cough, conjunctivitis with lacrymation, increase in fever.
- Pain all over the body is indicative of generalised muscular spasm leading to increase in body temperature presented to the physician with multiple bodyache.
- This is associated with initial phase of manifestation of fever. This can be attributable to poor blood supply to central nervous system as there is redistribution of the fluid takes place to the integumentary system.
- This can be attributable to increased fluid loss from the body. As far as the progression of the fever is concerned, the subsidence of fever takes place via three different routes either by urine or by sweat or by expired air. When the person is having fever, due to the increased fluid loss, he may have giddiness.
- This is attributable to maculo popular rashes which commence at the hairline and behind the ears, spreads down the trunk and limbs including palms and soles.
- The term *Vaivarnya* literally means discolouration of the skin. Contextually, it has to be abnormal textures of the skin. All these varieties of skin eruptions i.e. macules, papules, vesicles and pustules are observed in the individual at a particular time period.
- Conjunctivitis with lacrimation is one of the feature observed in the patient of chickenpox. This can be attributable to spread of infection to the eyes via nasolacrimal duct.
- Most of the features of *Masurika* are similar to the description of chickenpox. In chickenpox, the skin eruptions at a particular time vary from macule, papule, vesicle and pustule.
-

Daha (burning sensation),

• Jvara²³ (raised body temperature),

• Rujā²⁴ (pain),

• Tamra Sphota²⁵ (coppery coloured skin eruptions) which may turn into Pita Varna (yellowish discolouration) observed in different parts of the body as well as face.

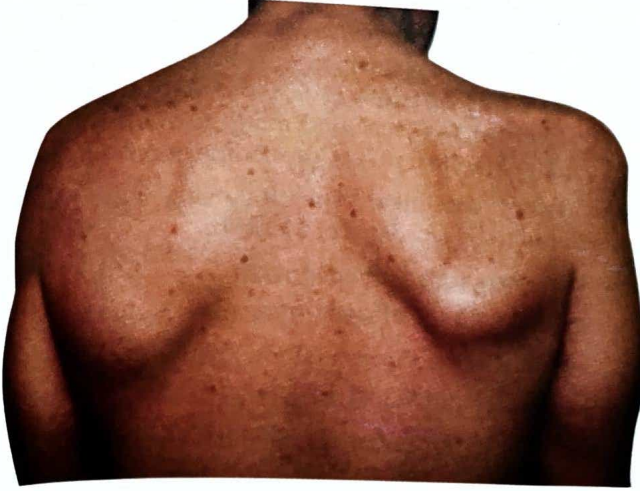


Figure 40: Pratyatma Lakshana of Masurika

Types of Masurika

8 types: Vataja, Pittaja, Kaphaja, Raktaja, Sannipataja, Vatapittaja, Vatakaphaja, Pittakaphaja

7 types: Rasadhatugata, Raktadhatugata, Mamsadhatugata, Medodhatugata, Asthidhatugata, Majjadhatugata, Shukradhatugata

Lakshana of Masurika Bheda

Vataja Masurika

स्फोटाः श्यावारुणा रूक्षस्तीव्रवेदनयाऽन्विताः।

कठिनाश्चिरपाकाश्च भवन्त्यनिलसम्भवाः॥

सन्ध्यस्थिपर्वणां भेदः कासः कम्पोऽरतिः क्लमः।

शोषस्ताल्बोष्ठजिह्वानां तृष्णा चारुचिसंयुता॥

मा.नि. - 54/4-6

Skin eruptions which are black in colour, rough in texture, severe pain, hard on presson the lesion, delayed suppuration, associated with pain in large joints, bones and small joints; cough, tremors, restlessness, exhaustion, dryness of the palate, lips and tongue, thirst and anorexia

Pittaja Masurika

रक्ताः पीतसिताः स्फोटाः सदाहास्तीव्रवेदनाः।

भवन्त्यचिरपाकाश्च पित्तकोपसमुद्भवाः॥

विड्भेदाश्चाङ्गमदी दाहस्तेणारुचिस्तथा।

मुखपाकोऽक्षिरागा ज्वरस्तीव्रः सुदारुणः॥

मा.नि. - 54/6-8

Skin eruptions which are red in base and yellow at the tip, associated with severe burning sensation and pain, quick suppuration, diarrhoea, general malaise, burning sensation, thirst, loss of appetite, stomatitis, redness of the eyes, high degree of fever. Pittaja Masurika is difficult to treat.

Raktaja Masurika

Raktaja Masurika is characterised by signs and symptoms similar to those of Pittaja Masurika.

Kaphaja Masurika

कफप्रसेकः स्तैमित्यं शिरोरुग् गात्रगौरवम्।

हृल्लासः सारुचिनिद्रा तन्द्रालस्य समन्विताः॥

श्वेताः स्निग्धा भृशं स्थूलाः कण्डूरा मन्दवेदनाः।

मसूरिकाः कफोत्था चिरपाकाः प्रकीर्तिताः॥

मा.नि. - 54/9-10

Excessive salivation, sensation of wetness of the body parts, headache, heaviness of the body parts, nausea along with loss of appetite, tastelessness, excessive sleep, lassitude, stupor. The skin eruptions are white in colour, slimy in texture, big in size that gives itching, mild pain. These lesions suppurate slowly.

Tridoshaja Masurika

नीलाश्चिपिट विस्तीर्णा मध्ये निम्ना महारुजः।

चिरपाकाः पृतिस्त्रावाः प्रभूताः सर्वदोषजाः॥

कण्ठरोधरुचि स्तम्भ प्रलापारतिसंयुताः।

दुश्चिकित्स्याः समुद्दिष्टाः पिडकाश्चर्मसंज्ञिताः॥

मा.नि. - 54/11-12

This is also being termed as Charmapidaka. In this type of Masurika, the skin eruptions are blue in colour, flat, depressed at the centre, very painful, suppurate slowly, exudes pus which is foul smell that is large in quantity; obstruction at the throat, loss of appetite, stiffness, delirium and restlessness.

Dhatugata Masurika

Tvak Gata Masurika:

तोयबुद्बुदसङ्काशाः त्वग्गतास्तु मसूरिकाः।

स्वल्पदोषाः प्रजायन्ते भिन्नास्तोयं स्रवन्ति च॥

मा.नि. - 54/14

The skin eruptions resemble like bubbles of water. It exudes thin water fluid on breaking. It is associated with signs and symptoms of vitiated Dosha which are mild in nature.

23 As the disease is considered to be viral disease afflicting respiratory system, he may have appearance of fever.

24 This is attributable to the myalgia which is observed as a result of increased heat production in muscular tissue.

25 At the early stage of the infection, all the skin rashes are having erythematous base in the maculopapular rashes. Coppery coloured discolouration is commonly observed after healing of skin rashes in the patient of measles or vesicles. Yellowish discolouration in the skin is observed when the vesicles are filled with pus which is termed as pustule.

Raktagata Masurika

रक्तस्था लोहिताकाराः शीघ्रपाकास्तनुत्वचः।
साध्या नात्यर्थदुष्टाश्च भिन्ना रक्तं स्रवन्ति च॥

मा.नि. - 54/15

The skin eruptions will be red and undergo suppuration quickly, the skin covering the lesion will be thin and therefore these eruptions bleed quickly after pricking. This type of *Masurika* is difficult to treat.

Mamsagata Masurika

मांसस्था कठिनाः स्निग्धारिपाका घनत्वचः।
गात्रशूल तृषा कण्डु ज्वरतिसमन्विताः॥

मा.नि. - 54/16

The skin eruptions are hard, slimy and suppurate slowly because the lesion is covered with thick skin. This is associated with symptoms like pain all over the body, thirst, itching, fever and restlessness.

Medogata Masurika

मेदजा मण्डलाकारा मृदवः किञ्चिदुन्नताः।
घोरज्वरपरीताश्च स्थूलाः स्निग्धाः संवेदनाः॥
संमोहारति सन्तापाः कश्चिदाभ्यो विनिस्तरेत्॥

मा.नि. - 54/17-18

Skin eruptions are round, soft, slightly elevated and big. It is slimy and painful. The patient develops high grade fever, delusion, restlessness, distress and only few persons get rid off this condition.

Asthi Majjagata Masurika

क्षुद्रा गात्रसमा रूक्षाश्चिपिटाः किञ्चिदुन्नताः।
मज्जोत्था भृशसम्मोह वेदनारतिसंयुताः॥
छिन्दन्ति मर्मधामानि प्राणानाशु हरन्ति हि।
भ्रमरेणो विद्वानि कुर्वन्त्यस्थीनि सर्वतः॥

मा.नि. - 54/18-20

The skin eruptions are small and are usually at the level of the skin. These are rough in touch, flat or slightly elevated. These are associated with symptoms such as delusion, pain, restlessness, cutting type of pain in vital organs, severe pain in the bones as if stung by bees. This variety of *Masurika* may take away the life of the individual.

Shukragata Masurika

पक्वाभाः पिडका स्निग्धाः सूक्ष्माश्चात्यर्थवेदनाः।
स्तैमित्यारतिसंमोहदाहोन्माद समन्विताः॥

मा.नि. - 54/20-22

Skin eruptions which are ripe, slimy, minute in structure, severe pain associated with feeling of covering of wet clothes over the body parts, restlessness, delusion, burning sensation and death is certain.

Sadhyasadhyata

- *Rasadhata*, *Raktadhata*, *Pittaja*, *Kaphaja* and *Kapha Pittaja* varieties of *Masurika* are easily curable.
- *Vataja*, *Vata Pittaja*, *Kapha Vataja* varieties are difficult to cure. These varieties should be treated with great effort and care.
- *Sannipataja* variety of *Masurika* is incurable. Signs and symptoms of *Sannipataja Masurika* are development of skin eruptions which resemble either colour of coral beads of fruits of *Jambu* or like an iron sieve or like fruits of *Atasi* and many such colours which usually manifest due to the combination of *Doshas*.

Upadrava of Masurika: The following *Lakshana* are considered to be *Upadrava* of *Masurika*.

मसूरिकान्ते शोथः स्यात् कूपरी मणिबन्धके।
तथाऽसफलके चापि दुश्चिकित्स्यः सुदारुणः॥

मा.नि. - 54/31

- Swelling in the *Kurpara* (elbow) region
- Swelling in the *Manibandha* (wrist) region
- Swelling in the *Amsaphalaka* (shoulder) region²⁶

Introduction

Romantika is a type of skin eruption. As per *Madhukosha* commentary, this is a variety of *Masurika*. It is preceded by raised body temperature followed by reddish skin eruptions. It implies the involvement of *Rasa* and *Rakta Dhatu* during the pathogenesis. This is not explained by *Sushruta*. This is explained by *Madhavakara* in the description of *Masurika*.

रोमकूपोन्नतिसमा रागिण्यः कफपित्तजाः।

कासारोचकसंयुक्ता रोमान्त्यो ज्वरपूर्विकाः॥

मा.नि. - 54/13

*Romantika*²⁷ is characterised by skin eruptions which arise at the root of hair follicles with slight elevation. They are red in colour. It is caused due to the dominance of *Kapha* and *Pitta Dosh*. there can be association of the symptoms like *Kasa* (cough) and *Arochaka* (tastelessness). The disease is always preceded by *Jvara* (raised body temperature).

मसूरिकायाः प्रकारं रोमान्तिकामाह - रोमकूपोन्नतिसमा इत्यादि।
रागिण्य इति लोहिताः, ज्वरपूर्विका इति ज्वरपूर्वरूपाः॥

मधु, मा.नि. 54/13

- मसूरिकायाः प्रकारं रोमान्तिकामाह - रोमकूपोन्नतिसमा इत्यादि- This is a variety of *Masurika*. In this disease, there will be elevations in the skin, at the root of hair follicles in particular.
- रागिण्य इति लोहिताः - the colour of skin eruptions is red in colour

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26 The swellings observed in these areas is considered to be difficult to cure or it may take longer time.
27 The clinical features of measles resemble the clinical features of *Romantika*. Measles is a highly contagious disease with characteristic clinical feature and presence of

ज्वरपूर्विका इति ज्वरपूर्वरूपाः – *Romantika*²⁸ is usually associated with *Jvara* (raised body temperature) as premonitory symptom.

Clinical feature	Dosha involved	Dushya involved	Srotas involved
Kasa	Vata and Kapha	Rasa	Pranavaha and Rasavaha
Arochaka	Kapha	Rasa	Annavaha/Rasavaha
Jvara	Pitta	Rasa	Rasavaha
Saraga Romakupa Unnati	Pitta and Kapha	Rasa and Rakta	Rasavaha and Raktavaha

Samprapti Ghataka

- Dosha involved :** *Kapha, Pitta, Vata* in the order of clinical presentation
- Dushya involved :** *Rasa, Rakta*
- Srotas involved :** *Pranavaha, Annavaha, Rasavaha, Raktavaha*
- Srotodushti Prakara:** *Sanga, Vimargagamana*
- Agni :** *Jatharagnimandya*
- Ama :** *Mahasrotas and Rasadhatu*
- Udbhava Sthana :** *Amashaya* (as this disease is *Upasargaja Vikara*, first there will be appearance of discomfort and *Amashaya* will be *Udbhava Sthana* after a period of 7 days)

- Sanchara Sthana :** *Sarva Sharira*
- Vyakta Sthana :** *Tvak*
- Rogamarga :** *Abhyantara, Bahya* in the order of clinical presentation
- Vyadhyavastha :** *Ashukari*
- Sadhyasadhya :** *Sukhasadhya*

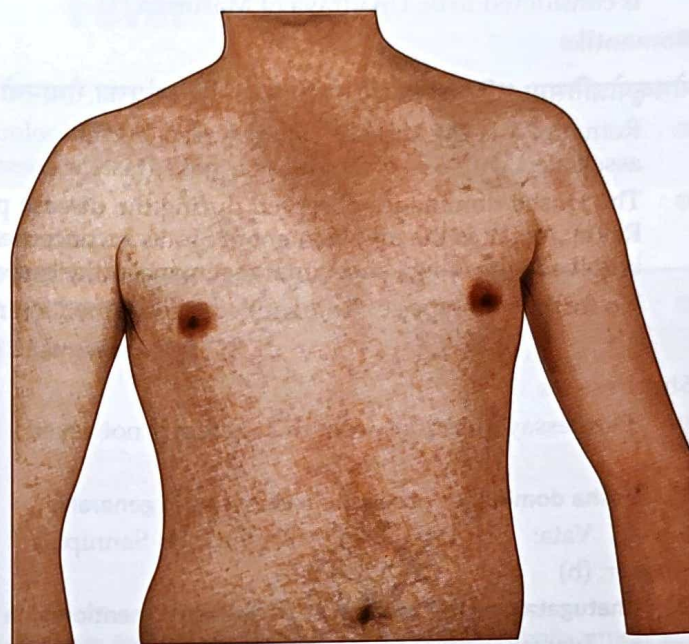


Figure 41: Clinical features of measles

Key summary of the chapter Masurika

- दाहज्वररुजावन्तस्ताम्राः स्फोटाः सपीतकाः। गात्रेषु वदनं चान्तर्विज्ञेयास्ता मसूरिकाः॥ सु.नि. - 13/36
- This is *Upasargajanya Vikara*. This is associated with skin eruptions that are associated with burning sensation, fever, pain and coppery coloured skin eruptions which may turn into yellowish discolouration observed in different parts of the body and face.
- This is associated with *Pitta Dosha* vitiation and *Rakta Dhatu* involvement.
- Purvarupa of *Masurika* are fever, itching, bodyache, restlessness, giddiness, swelling of the skin, discolouration and redness of the eyes.
- तासां पूर्व ज्वरः कण्डूर्गात्रभङ्गोऽरतिर्भ्रमः। त्वचि शोथः सवैवर्ण्यी नैत्ररागश्च जायते॥ मा.नि. - 54/4
- Samanya Lakshana of *Masurika* are burning sensation, fever, discomfort, coppery coloured skin eruptions, yellowish coloured blisters formation in the body parts and face.
- दाहज्वररुजावन्तस्ताम्राः स्फोटाः सपीतकाः। गात्रेषु वदनं चान्तर्विज्ञेयास्ता मसूरिकाः॥ सु.नि. - 13/36

- ²⁸ • Measles is caused by RNA virus measles virus. Measles virus invades respiratory epithelium and spreads via blood stream to the reticuloendothelial system from which it infects the white blood cells leading to infection of the skin, respiratory tract and other organs.
- Measles begins with a 2 to 4 days of malaise, running nose, cough, conjunctivitis, lachrymation along with fever. At this stage, the skin rashes will not appear and the features mimic the features of influenza. Just before the appearance of skin rashes, the person will have 1-2 mm sized bluish white spots on the buccal mucosa on a bright red background. Koplik's spots are seen alongside the second molars.
- Later, the person may have erythematous, nonpruritic, maculopapular rashes begin at the hairline and behind the ears, later spreads down the trunk and limbs to include the palms and soles. By 4th day of appearance of rash, the skin rashes appear to fade in the order in which they appeared. Brownish discolouration of skin and desquamation may appear later. Fever subsides 4th or 5th day of appearance of rash.
- Prolonged fever may be the complication of measles. Lymphadenopathy, diarrhoea, vomiting and splenomegaly are common features observed in measles.

- Types of Masurika are 8 types based on the Dosha dominance – Vataja, Pittaja, Kaphaja, Sannipataja, Vatapittaja, Pittakaphaja, Vatakaphaja and 7 types based on the involvement of Dhatu – Rasadhatugata, Raktadhatugata, Mamsadhatugata, Medodhatugata, Asthidhatugata, Majjadhatugata, Shukradhatugata. Among these types, Rasadhatugata, Raktadhatugata, Pittaja, Kaphaja and Kaphapittaja varieties of Masurika are Sukhasadhya (easily curable); Vataja, Vatapittaja, Kaphavataja varieties of Masurika are Krichrasadhya (difficult to cure) and Sannipataja variety of Masurika is Asadhya (incurable).
- If the swelling is seen in Kurpara (elbow), Manibandha (wrist) and Amsaphalaka (shoulder) joints, then Lakshana is considered to be Upadrava of Masurika.

Romantika

- रोमकूपोन्नतिसमा रागिण्यः कफपित्तजाः। कासारोचकसंयुक्ता रोमान्त्यो ज्वरपूर्विकाः॥
- मा.नि. - 54/13
- Romantika is the disease characterised by red coloured skin eruptions which arise at the root of hair follicles associated with Kasa (cough), Arochaka (tastelessness) and Jvara (raised body temperature).
 - The Dosha dominance observed during the disease progression are Kapha and Pitta. This disease involves Rasa, Rakta. As far as the involvement of Srotas is concerned Pranavaha, Annavaha, Rasavaha and Raktavaha Srotas are involved with Sanga and Vimargagamana as the type of Srotodushti afflicted during the progression of the disease.
 - No further subtypes of Romantika are explained in any of the Ayurveda textbooks.

Self-Assessment: Questions for Review

Short essays

- Short essay questions from this section is not asked

MCQs

- Dosha dominance observed in Masurika in general is
a. Vata; b. Pitta; c. Kapha; d. Sannipata
Answer: (b)
- Dhatugata Avastha as the type of disease is mentioned in
a. Jvara; b. Kushtha;
c. Masurika; d. All of the above
Answer: (d)
- Vataja type of Masurika is considered to be
a. Sukhasadhya; b. Krichrasadhya;
c. Asadhya; d. Pratyakhyeya
Answer: (b)
- The type of skin lesion in Masurika is having
a. Aruna Varna; b. Tamra Varna;
c. Shveta Varna; d. Pita Varna
Answer: (b)
- Sankhya Samprapti of Masurika is
a. 7 types; b. 6 types;
c. 4 types; d. 13 types
Answer: (a)
- Dosha dominance in the manifestation of Romantika is/
are
a. Vata and Pitta; b. Kapha and Pitta;
c. Vata and Kapha; d. Vata, Pitta and Kapha
Answer: (b)
- Dhatu involved in the manifestation of Romantika is/are
a. Rasa; b. Rakta;
c. Rasa and Rakta; d. Shukra
Answer: (c)
- Romantika is a type of
a. Shvitra; b. Masurika; c. Kaksha; d. Visarpa
Answer: (b)

9. Koplik's spots are pathognomonic of

- Chickenpox;
- Measles;
- Smallpox;
- Ramsay Hunt syndrome

Answer: (b)

10. Koplik's spots are seen in which part of the body?

- Skin;
- Nasal mucosa;
- Oral mucosa;
- Anal mucosa

Answer: (c)

Chapter resources

- Madhava Nidana – 54th chapter, Masurika Nidana
- Yoga Ratnakara – Masurika Nidana
- Madhava Nidana 54th chapter: Masurika Nidana
- Golwalla's medicine for students by Aspi F Golwalla and Sharukh A Golwalla, edited by Milind Y Nadkar, 25th edition, Jaypee Brothers Medical Publishers (P) Ltd, New Delhi, 2017
- The Merck Manual of Diagnosis and Therapy by Robert S Porter and Justin L Kaplan, 19th edition, Merck Sharp & Dohme Corp, New Jersey, 2011
- Chamberlain's symptoms and signs in clinical medicine by Colin Ogilvie and Christopher C Evans, 12th edition, Butterworth-Heinemann Publishers, 1997
- Best & Taylor's physiological basis of medical practice by O P Tandon and Y Tripathi, 13th edition, Wolters Kluwer Health (India) Pvt. Ltd, Gurgaon, 2012
- Textbook of Medical physiology by Arthur C Guyton and John E Hall, 11th edition, Saunders Elsevier publications, Philadelphia, 2006
- Harrison's principles and practice of internal medicine by Anthony S Fauci et al, 17th edition, McGraw Hill Publications, New York, 2008
- www.bing.com